An entirely separate book would be required to do proper justice to their contributions, but Adrian Birrell was our assistant coach, providing exceptional support to Russell Domingo; Allan Donald proved an outstanding bowling coach, respected by everybody; and Claude Henderson excelled as our spin-bowling coach. Gary Kirsten and Mike Hussey, two highly skilled and highly experienced cricket men, had been recruited as invaluable consultants, saying all the right things at all the right times.

Dr Mohammed Moosajee was always an efficient, highly organised and sympathetic team manager, while Lerato Malekutu continued to manage the media with a smile, which was no mean achievement. Greg King performed regular miracles as our strength and conditioning coach, and Brandon Jackson was a talented and brilliant physiotherapist.

Riaan Muller managed our logistics, proving himself to be a conscientious and committed individual who ensured our complex travel plans were executed without a hitch, while Zunaid Wadee was the ultimate professional as our chief protection officer. Prasanna Agoram proved a top-class analyst, and Michelle Schmidt took on the crucial role of looking after our wives and families when they joined us on tour.

Tony Irish, Chief Executive of the South African Cricketers' Association (SACA), was another important contributor; he has for many years played a highly significant role in the smooth running of the Proteas and South African cricket in general, always supporting the players and always finding solutions. He has become a good friend to many of us.

Our World Cup campaign seemed to be gathering momentum and the little green book was passed to Dr Moosajee, who finished his notes by writing: 'Prior to our departure for the Cricket World Cup, someone I know well remarked that South Africa have never won a World Cup because, as a country and as a cricket community, we were not as yet ready for it. He further stated the team environment and culture, epitomised in the Protea Fire campaign, is set up in a way that, irrespective of the outcome, we will leave it all out there on the field and we will always